

The three clouds

Clouds come in all kinds of shapes and sizes, but they are all made of billions of tiny water droplets or even ice crystals floating in the sky. There are three basic types—wispy “cirrus” clouds, fluffy white “cumulus” clouds, and huge blankets of “stratus” clouds.



Cirrus clouds

Feathery cirrus clouds form very high up in the sky. It is so cold up there that they are made not of water droplets, but of tiny ice crystals.

Cirrus clouds high up in the sky often signal bad weather.

Mare's tails

Cirrus clouds are often called mare's tails, because strong winds high in the air blow them into wispy curls—just like the tail of a horse.